

BATTLE DOWN UNDER: A GENERATION'S LAST STAND

Irrespective of which way this Border-Gavaskar series swings, it will be the final one for many **stalwarts** across both teams, with the next edition slated for early 2027.

Pranay Rajiv and Dhruva Prasad

pranay.rajiv@thehindu.co.in,
dhruva.prasad@thehindu.co.in

In a country besotted with cricket, it is not uncommon to see the term 'Indian cricket is at the crossroads' thrown about frivolously in the media and amongst the frenzied fans.

But with a coveted dominance in Tests at home curtailed, courtesy of the Kiwis, and the heat on the Indian team at its zenith following the failure of stalwarts, the upcoming five-match series Down Under could well be an inflection point.

The Indians don't have the most formidable record in Australia by any stretch of the imagination. With just nine wins across 52 Tests in the country, England, West Indies, and South Africa are historically well ahead in taking the fight to arguably cricket's most unforgiving host.

However, getting down to brass tacks reveals that four of those nine wins have come in back-to-back series wins over the last six years, with the Indians showing more of